refused to find me a lowly teaching assistant's job in the Department of History at Hebrew University. (Following my two years with Goldmann, I could not continue moving from New York to Jerusalem and back, because I had gotten married and we had a child; thus I found a position in the Defense Ministry, where I worked as an assistant to Shimon Peres). I enjoyed the irony when in 1967 I was called from Geneva to Jerusalem to fill in for Talmon, who was leaving for a year at Princeton. Moshe Dayan, the much-acclaimed defense minister at the time, hated Talmon, and used a quote from Isaiah 41 calling him *tolaat Yaakov* (thou worm Jacob). Of course, Talmon was right, and today we face the consequences.

Monday, January 30

US Secretary of State Antony Blinken is in Israel, talking to Netanyahu. Let's hope that American warnings, if warnings there are, are not too half-hearted and that they address both the Palestinian issue and the anti-democratic policies of the coalition.

Some fifty law professors from American universities—among them Alan Dershowitz, in the past quite close to Netanyahu— have signed an open letter against the judicial reform project of our PM and his stooge Levin. I doubt that this will help; only US political pressure can. But will there be pressure?

Tuesday, January 31

It seems that there isn't a chance that Biden will press Netanyahu regarding the country's internal policies or even about the two-state solution. The US declarations are supposedly empty words; there are simply too many international problems that dominate American–Israeli relations (Iran, Ukraine, extending the Abraham agreements to additional Arab states, etc.).